

Health Care Service Coordination: As described in detail above, the SEAGO AAA issues a competitive Request for Applications to select the best-qualified service providers and ensure competition in arranging for services for elderly individuals and their caregivers. In their proposals, prospective service providers are asked to describe how they will coordinate benefits with any other programs that serve the elderly or disabled, how they will coordinate activities with county long-term care programs, Medicare and ALTCS, and how the provider will ensure that these fund sources are maximized to use AAA funding only when no other source is available, in order to ensure coordination of services and integration of multiple funding sources. Cost Share is encouraged, and case managers, service providers, and AAA monitor these contributions.

Title VII Efforts: The SEAGO AAA will continue to host the Region VI Conference of Aging, where information on Long Term Care Ombudsman, SHIP, and SMP programs are featured. While it was not possible to host the conference during SFY21, our intention stands once we can do it safely from Covid. SEAGO will continue to hold workshops on Medicare, advanced directives, and selecting LTC policies, as well as scam jams across the region. Besides, case-managed services target those who lack a support system, low income, and those who are most vulnerable, including adult protective service referrals. Participation in community meetings, training, health and resource fairs, and other events will offer opportunities to get the word out about LTC Ombudsman, SHIP, SMP programs and services, and how to prevent, detect, and report abuse neglect, and financial exploitation of older adults. As new training modules are out at the state level, these modules will be adopted, and once completed, the LTCO will make an effort to recruit more volunteers in the area. The Long Term Care Ombudsman program and the State Health Insurance Program are collaborating in building an Elder Fraud and Abuse taskforce in Cochise county. We see that with the multiple changes happening since COVID, we must educate and inform our communities. We have organizations that work with the elderly as partners that will help the Area Agency on Aging address the needs of those affected or reduce the number of cases throughout our region.

Other: SEAGO-AAA Management Analyst oversees the Case Management program, and since her partaking, we see even more impact in the program. She coordinates services and funding availability amongst the case managers and service providers to assist the director in projecting future spending. She provides training and guidance to our case managers on changes happening within the organization. The modification is preparing our Management Analysis for when SEAGO-AAA begins to bring the case management in-house. With a grant obtained through the Legacy Foundation of Southeast Arizona and the David and Lura Lovell Foundation, the Area Agency on Aging has successfully adopted End of Life Care Matters since 2018. With the dedication and support from Veronica "Ronnie" Squyres, we are successfully going into our third year. Thus far, we have accomplished our goal to expand our services throughout the four-county region by hosting Thoughtful Life Conversations workshops. Our goal has been to normalize and increase conversations by providing several venues for discussing and planning for end-of-life issues and healthcare planning, including advance directives. We have developed our Workplace Initiative (WPI) to provide education to organizations that provide healthcare and social services to patients and clients. We have reached over 600 participants, over 40 workshops and partnered with 19 local organizations. There is representation from the Area Agency on Aging in the AZ Health Directive Registry committee for the transition. We commit ourselves to help make this transition a huge success.